

and traditions, while the first Europeans to visit Australia recorded their impressions of the Eora women of Sydney in journals and drawings. A number of the women featured in these journals are remembered today. Patyegarang, for example, helped British marines officer William Dawes to record the Eora language. Barangaroo, a fisherwoman and hunter, is recalled for refusing to wear European clothes and for her compassion when she witnessed a white convict being flogged for stealing—she tried to grab the whip out of the flogger’s hands.

Colonization had a devastating impact on the indigenous Australian women. The “stolen generations” (the forced removal of children from their mothers) is just one shocking aspect of their experience. Women also encountered violence at the hands of the



▲ **Ritual fishhook**

This 18th-century carved *mataua* fishhook is characteristic of Nagati Tahu of South Island. The Maoris used such hooks to catch fish for gods, priests, and chiefly women.



IN BRIEF

SETTLEMENT HISTORY

The colonization of Australia and New Zealand has informed women’s activism, in particular that of indigenous women who have had to fight racism and patriarchy.

1700

- **1769** James Cook lands at Poverty Bay, North Island.
- **1788** About 192 female convicts arrive in New South Wales on the First Fleet.

1800

- **1806** Convict Charlotte Badger escapes from New South Wales and is one of the first European women to live in New Zealand.
- **1814** Jane Kendall, Hannah King, and Dinah Hall help their husbands found the first settlement of the Church Missionary Society at Rangihoua, North Island.
- **1840** Māori women are signatories for the Treaty of Waitangi with the British government.
- **1861** Propertied women are awarded the vote in local elections in South Australia.
- **1888** Kate Sheppard publishes *The Ten Reasons Why the Women of New Zealand Should Vote*.
- **1890s** Māori women join the Women’s Christian Temperance Union and the fight for suffrage.

1900

- **1901** The state of Queensland criminalizes informal marriages between Aboriginal women and non-Aboriginal men.
- **1962** Aboriginal women and men are given the right to vote in Australian federal elections.
- **1967** Aboriginal women and men are allowed to become Australian citizens.
- **1975** Whina Cooper leads the first Māori land rights march. It starts the land movement.
- **1997** The *Bringing Them Home* report into the stolen generation reveals that between one in three and one in 10 indigenous children were removed from their mothers from 1910–1970.

◀ **MAORI WOMEN CELEBRATE THEIR HISTORIC MIGRATION FROM POLYNESIA TO NEW ZEALAND AT A FESTIVAL, 1950.**

